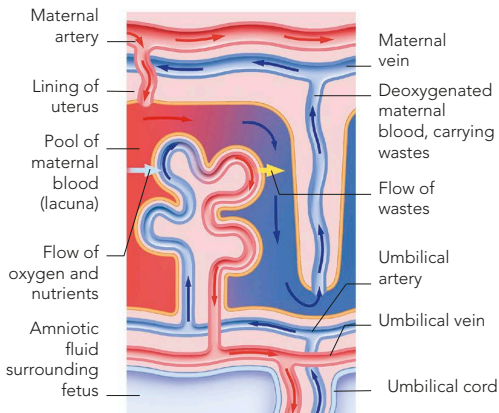
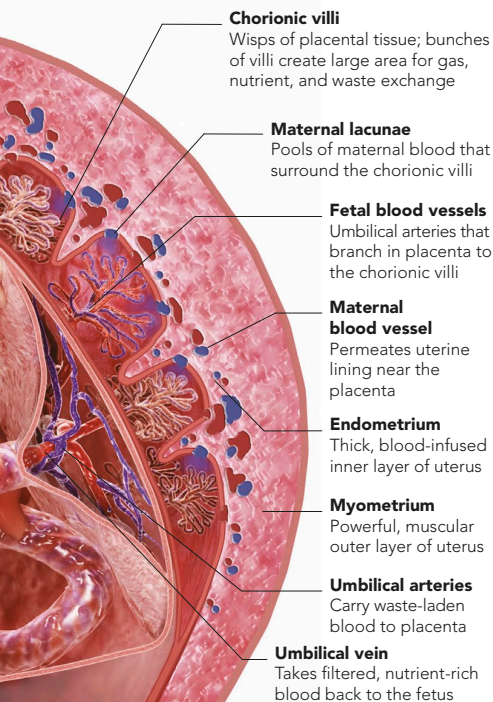


HOW THE PLACENTA WORKS

Oxygen, nutrients, and antibodies pass from the mother to the fetus in the umbilical veins; fetal waste passes to the mother in the umbilical arteries.

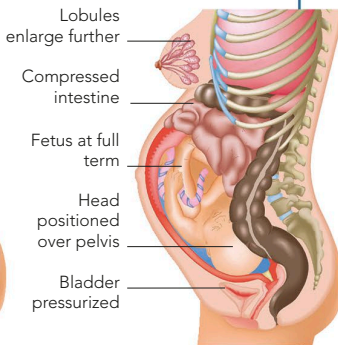
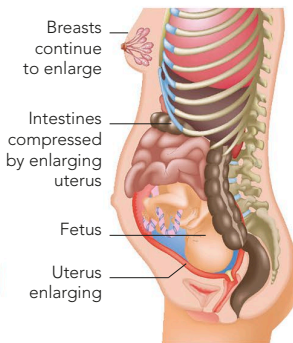
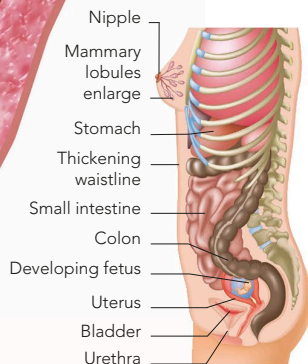


EXCHANGE OF OXYGEN AND NUTRIENTS

A thin barrier of cells in the chorion allows the exchange of gases, nutrients, and waste between mother and fetus.

CHANGES IN THE MOTHER

Pregnancy is divided into trimesters, each lasting about three calendar months. During this time, the mother's body changes to support the fetus and to prepare itself for childbirth and breast-feeding.



FIRST TRIMESTER

Breasts become tender and larger, with darkened areolas; nausea and vomiting are common.

SECOND TRIMESTER

Enlarging uterus shows; heart rate increases; forehead and cheek skin may temporarily darken.

THIRD TRIMESTER

Abdominal skin stretches; fatigue, back pain, heartburn, and some breathlessness may occur.